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The cell phone has become a ubiquitous device. The key benefit of mobile gaming content is that it brings interactivity to the table by providing those five minutes of entertainment, and thus making it an exciting marketing avenue. The uptake for some games is fantastic, as long as they are developed and promoted well. There are five crore consumers in India using cell phones.

Mauj recently powered the *Sarkar* video game (a strategy-based game) on Cell One Galaxy, BSNL's GPRS portal prior to the film's release. *Sarkar* was one of the most-awaited movies of the year. So, its game launched with much fanfare also attracted many users.

It would take anywhere between one to five months to produce such a game—a lot depends on the complexity of the game, licensing, whether it's multi-player or not, and so on. Some film producers and product manufacturers are more involved than others. In such a case, the process is well-planned, detailed and done to perfection. We are developing videogames for the forthcoming movies—*My Wife's Murder* and *Shaadi Karke Phas Gaye Yaar*.

It's easier to make a videogame based on films as compared to other products, as films have an inherent entertainment value. While the TV and print media promote the product extensively, gaming is another weapon in the arsenal of marketers to reinforce the brand image.

GAME?



Neeraj Roy
MD and CEO
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Mobile and online gaming is, in any event, a popular genre of entertainment. However, wireless gaming is only accessible to mobile users with access to GPRS. The lack of it, shrinks the digital consumer population that can access mobile gaming content.

If you want to launch a game based on a film prior to its release, you need to understand the basics of film-marketing. A pre-release of the game promotes the film and helps build up the crescendo till its actual opening weekend. So, the launch of a game prior to the release of the film (or a product) goes hand-in-hand.

In India, promotional games are largely a last-minute addition, with 95 per cent offering poor game-play. Early involvement is vital for better ideation, as it takes two-three months to produce a high-quality game.

On the whole, though, it's a win-win situation for all—consumers get to win prizes, brand owners get high quality interactive time with their target audience, game developers are compensated and develop their own Intellectual Property.



Alok Kejriwal
CEO
Contests2Win

Gaming allows technology to be 'wrapped' cleverly, as brands deploy technology to manage consumers using the age, sex and location filters. Here, consumers 'play' with brands proactively and not 'avoid' them reactively, such as, switching channels when a commercial starts.

Time spent on a game exceeds a 30-second TV or Radio spot or a five-second visual glance at a print ad. Even, the timeline to produce a game is very short compared to a TV ad and is at 1/10th of the cost! A high quality game can deliver nearly one lakh plays in a month if promoted well.

In India, respondents are typically male, aged 20-30, and residing in the top 10 metros. For games in the predominantly female category (e.g., cosmetic products), responses are 50 per cent skewed towards females.

Clients spend nearly five to 10 lakh rupees per campaign to develop the game and the reach media plan. Planning is always done in advance, as the games are heavily customised! We've even made games for condom brands!

We will now see a 'fusion' marketing model emerge—as traditional marketing will create awareness and build brands, gaming will deliver the immersion and belief in the product that could lead to a sale. It seems to point to the future of interactive marketing, as specific mobile enabled games become *de rigueur*...

As told to Renuka Rane (renuka_rane@thinkdigit.com)